

Then come He in what watch soever,
 Go forth we will with ready feet,
 The Bridegroom's angel-host to meet,
 Who stand before Him, weary never.

Christmas Hymn. I.

O that the Salvation were given unto Israel out of Sion! O
 that the Lord would deliver His People out of captivity! Then
 should Jacob rejoice, and Israel should be right glad.

Ps. liii. 7, 8.



WE sing to Thee, Emmanuel,
 The Prince of Life, Salvation's Well,
 The Plant of Heaven, the Star of Morn,
 The Lord of lords, the Virgin-born!

All glory, worship, thanks, and praise,
 That Thou art come in these our days;
 Thou Heavenly Guest expected long,
 We hail Thee with a joyful song.

For Thee, since first the world was made,
 Men's hearts have waited, watched, and prayed;
 Prophets and patriarchs, year by year,
 Have longed to see Thy Light appear.

"O God," they prayed, "from Sion rise,
 And hear Thy captive people's cries;
 At length, O Lord, salvation bring,
 Then Jacob shall rejoice and sing!"

Nun bist Du hier, da liegest Du,
Hältst in dem Kripplein deine Ruh :
Bist klein und machst doch alles groß,
Bekleidst die Welt und kömmt doch bloß.

Du kehrst in fremder Haufung ein
Und find doch alle Himmel dein,
Trinkst Milch aus einer Menschenbrust,
Und bist doch selbst der Engel Lust.

So faß ich Dich nun ohne Scheu,
Du machst mich alles Jammers frei :
Du trägst den Zorn, Du zwingst den Tod,
Verkehrst in Freud all Angst und Noth.

Du bist mein Haupt, hinwiederum
Bin ich dein Glied und Eigenthum,
Und will, so viel dein Geist mir giebt,
Stets dienen Dir, wie Dirs beliebt.

Ich will dein Alleluia hier
Mit Freuden singen für und für :
Und dort in deinem Ehrensaal
Soll schallen ohne Zeit und Zahl.

PAUL GERHARD. 1606—1676.



**Now Thou, by Whom the world was made,
Art in Thy Manger-cradle laid,
Maker of all things great, art small,
Naked Thyself, though clothing all.**

**Thou Who both Heaven and earth dost sway,
In strangers' inn art fain to stay,
And though Thy power makes angels blest,
Dost seek Thy food from human breast.**

**Encouraged thus, our love grows bold
On Thee to lay our steadfast hold ;
The Cross which Thou didst undergo
Has vanquished Death, and healed our woe.**

**Thou art our Head, then, Lord, of Thee
True living members we will be,
And, in the strength Thy Grace shall give,
Will live as Thou wouldst have us live.**

**As each short year goes quickly round,
Our Alleluias shall resound ;
And, when we reckon years no more,
May we in heaven Thy Name adore.**

